

Kamal Joshi

Staff Backend Engineer | Go | AWS | Distributed Systems | API Platform | Data & AI Products

Austin, TX | Open to remote | Open to relocation for the right opportunity

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Backend Engineer with 18+ years of experience building scalable distributed systems, APIs, and platform services that power product experiences at scale. Proven track record of setting technical direction, driving hands-on implementation from prototype to production, and collaborating with product, ML, and data engineering teams to unlock data-driven capabilities. Expert at leading backend systems that support personalization, event delivery, and real-time data flows — and at translating ambiguous product problems into iterative architecture and execution strategies. Effective at mentoring engineers, championing best practices, and influencing cross-functional partners from IC to staff level. Over the last two years, highly effective at directing AI tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex) to accelerate delivery across the full SDLC while owning design quality and business outcomes.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Backend/platform engineering:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, webhooks, event-driven systems, microservices
- **Cloud & infrastructure:** AWS (Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD
- **Data & AI adjacency:** distributed data pipeline design (Kinesis, S3/Iceberg, EMR on EKS, DynamoDB streams), ML pipeline architecture analysis, API/backend serving layer for ML products
- **API & product platform:** Kong API Gateway, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, third-party integrations, rate limiting, multi-region readiness
- **Engineering leadership:** technical direction, design and code review, production ownership, cross-team coordination, mentoring, best-practices adoption
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex — daily use across implementation, IaC, testing, debugging, code review, and design exploration; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 – May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Owned backend platform services (API Gateway, Authorization Service, Integrations Service) end-to-end: architecture, API design, implementation, production support, and cross-team coordination.
- Led design and delivery of a real-time security-event delivery product using the open **CloudEvents** standard, shipping **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers — translating product ambiguity into a staged execution plan and on-time launch.
- Designed cross-service **API architecture** for customer-selectable webhook formats (Splunk HEC, CloudEvents) across four backend services, collaborating with product, backend, and data-pipeline teams to align on a unified data model and delivery contract.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and API gateway rate-limit behavior, unblocking the customer with a targeted mitigation and driving durable fixes around retry, token reuse, and service ownership boundaries.
- Prevented production message loss by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog** across **15 orgs** and redriving all messages within **5-10 minutes** — combining system-level diagnosis with fast, safe execution.
- Drove backend readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes (ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, service config, audit logging) and validating HA behavior across multiple regions.

- Analyzed multi-region failover architecture for a **data pipeline** spanning Kinesis Firehose, S3/Iceberg, EMR on EKS, SQS/SNS, and DynamoDB — identifying failure modes, ownership gaps, and recovery strategies in collaboration with ML and data teams.
- Reframed API onboarding as a control-plane problem and proposed a hybrid API + Terraform model to improve self-service speed while preserving auditability — influencing product and engineering strategy.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 – November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Advanced APIX platform capabilities across API gateway, authorization, integrations, and event-delivery domains; grew into full production ownership for backend platform services.
- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services to simplify OAuth 2.0 and policy enforcement integration — reducing duplication and accelerating onboarding for new services.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex) into daily engineering workflow across implementation, IaC, testing, code review, and design exploration; **pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption** ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and hands-on guidance; initiated “Tip Talk Tue,” a recurring team knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and best practices.
- Led ISMAP security certification for the APIX platform, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements across engineering, legal, and operations teams — delivered on deadline.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 – January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs for a **cloud-native data ingestion platform** using OpenTSDB for timeseries metrics — early hands-on work with real-time data pipelines and API-first platform design.
- Built API-driven authentication and authorization flows using OIDC, OAuth 2.0, and gRPC-Web; contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs and gRPC APIs from SQL schemas.
- Designed a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard, reducing friction for security analysts writing threat-hunting queries.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 – February 2015

- Delivered backend services, internal tools, workflow applications, and integration features across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Turned ambiguous requirements into working product features through rapid prototyping, stakeholder feedback, and iterative delivery.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University